



Daisies such as the **treasure flower**, the **common daisy**, and **chicory** have large outer petal-like ray florets, surrounding the disk florets in the center. Each disk floret is in fact five fused petals that form a tubelike flower, which you can see clearly in the **whorl flower**. The **sunflower** has a large head so you can make out the individual disk florets as they bloom, from the outside in.

Each floret produces one seed. The flower-packed heads of daisies make them much more attractive to insects and makes pollination a lot easier. Most have bright colors to attract insect pollinators, such as bees, but the tropical **Mutisia** flower is pollinated by birds. The other tropical daisies, **stiffia** and the **Maui island-aster**, are unusual because they grow on trees.

The largest sunflower head ever grown was in 1983, at 32 1/4 in (82 cm) across.

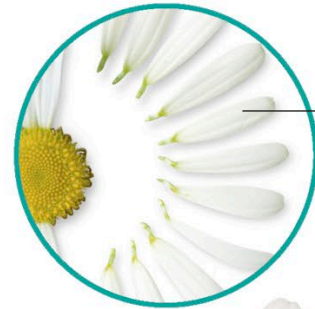


Sunflower



Mutisia

The orange ray florets attract bird pollinators.



Each petal-like ray floret is a lopsided flower.

Yellow disk florets at the center produce pollen and make seeds.



Common daisy



Edible blue flowers, which are bitter in taste, can be eaten in salads.

Chicory

The purple florets fade to cream toward the center of the flower head.



Persian cornflower